15 Candlestick Patterns

A one-picture-per-page visual guide

How to read the pictures

Green candle: price closed higher than it opened

Red candle: price closed lower than it opened

Thick part = body (open to close). Thin lines = wicks (high and low).

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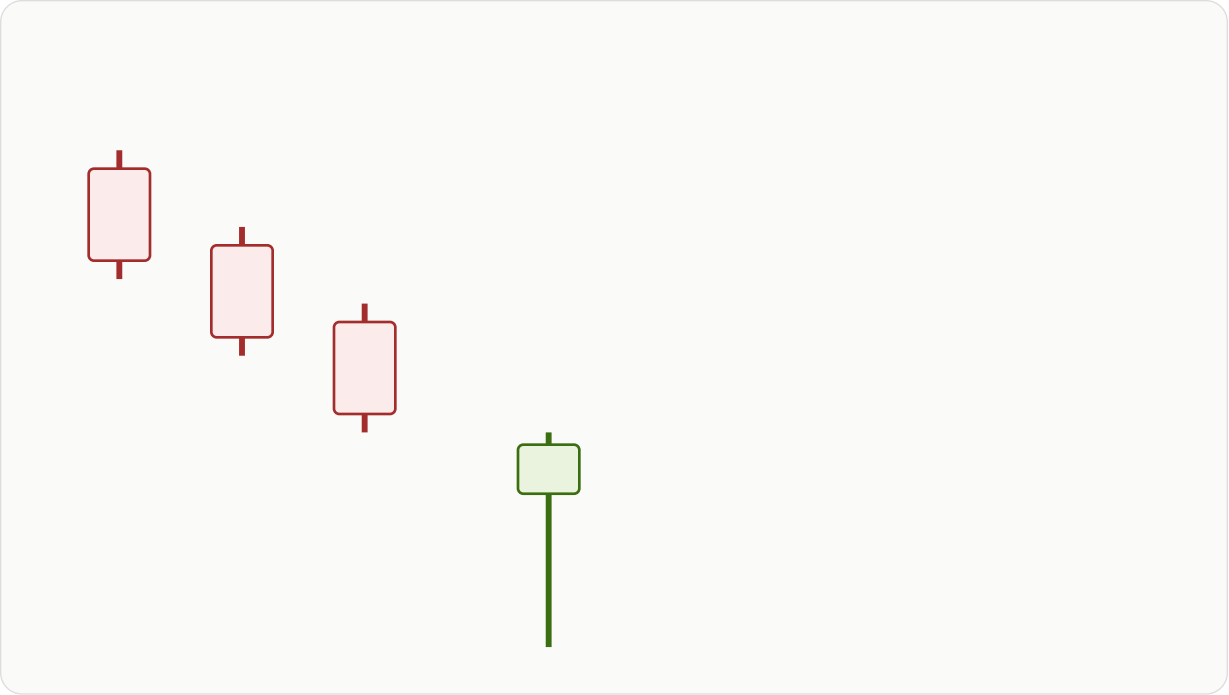
Educational use only. Not financial advice. No pattern works every time; always use a stop-loss.

PATTERN 1 OF 15 | BULLISH REVERSAL

Hammer

After a downtrend



What it means

Sellers pushed price far down during the session, but buyers fought back and pulled it up to close near the top. It shows buying strength appearing at the bottom of a drop.

What to look for

- Small body near the top of the candle
- Long lower wick, at least 2x the body
- Little or no upper wick
- Must appear after a clear downtrend

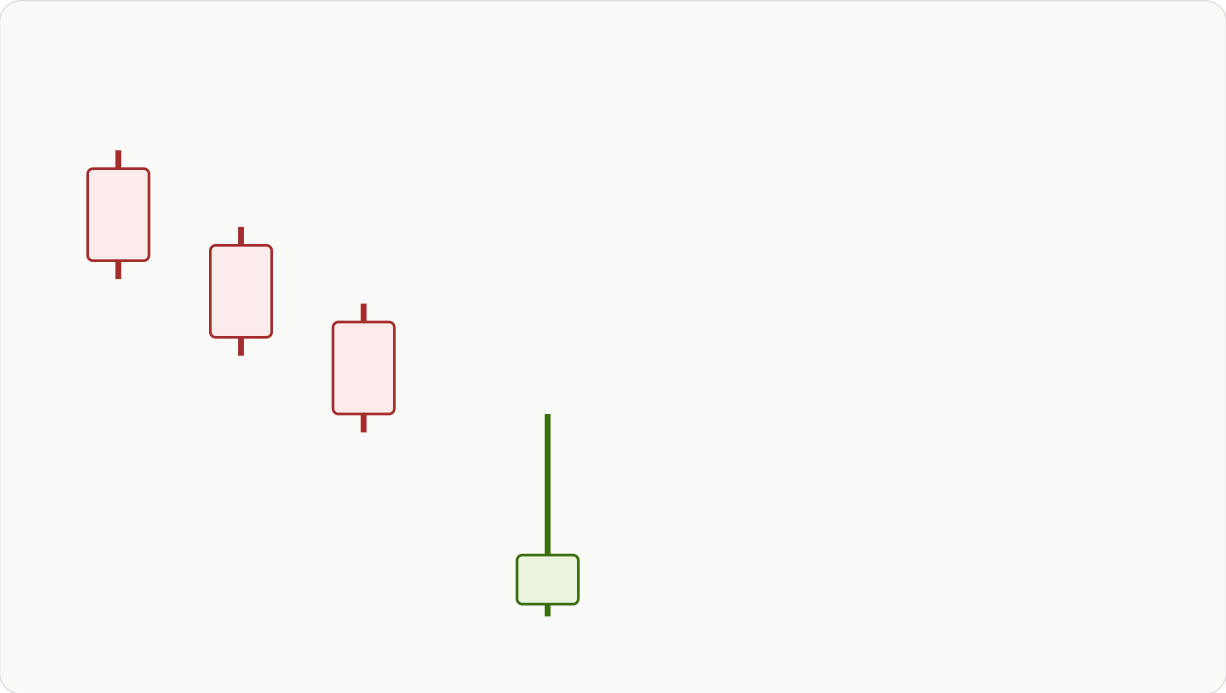
HOW TO USE IT

Wait for the next candle to close higher before trusting it.

PATTERN 2 OF 15 | BULLISH REVERSAL

Inverted Hammer

After a downtrend



What it means

Buyers tried to push price up and were pushed back by sellers, but the fact that buyers showed up at all after a fall is the first hint that selling pressure is weakening.

What to look for

- Small body near the bottom
- Long upper wick, at least 2x the body
- Little or no lower wick
- Must appear after a clear downtrend

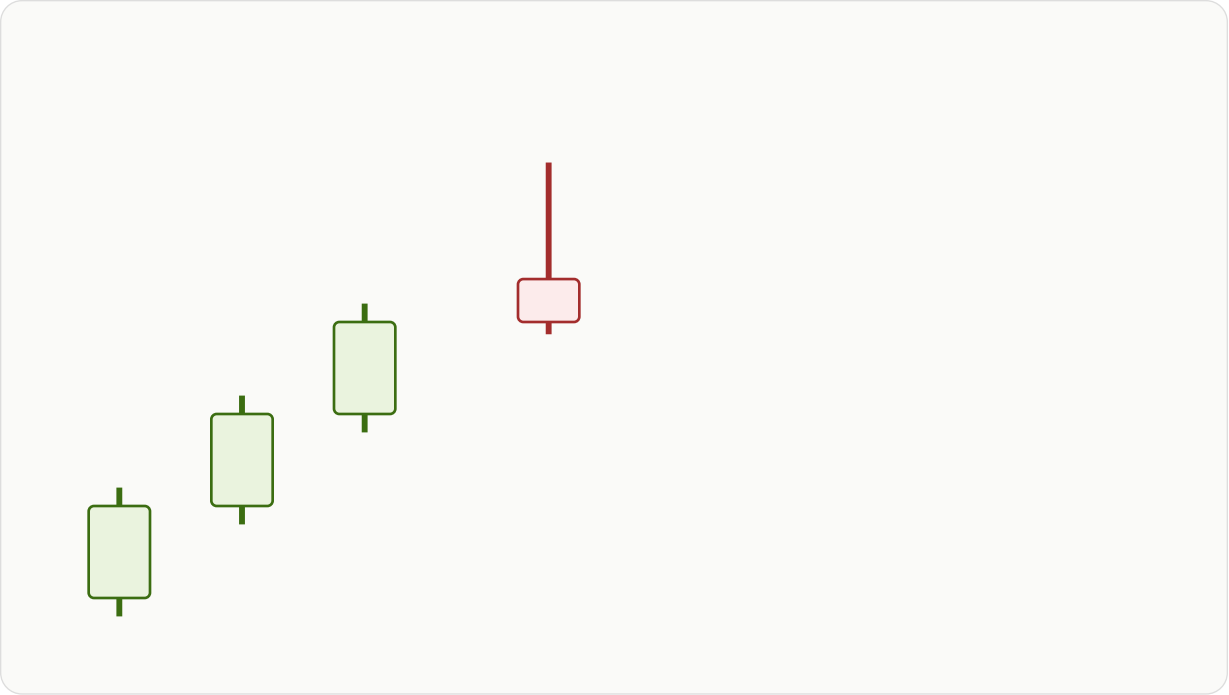
HOW TO USE IT

Needs confirmation. A higher close on the next candle makes it much stronger.

PATTERN 3 OF 15 | BEARISH REVERSAL

Shooting Star

After an uptrend



What it means

Buyers pushed price sharply higher, then sellers slammed it back down so it closed near the open. The failed rally warns that buyers are running out of strength.

What to look for

- Small body near the bottom
- Long upper wick, at least 2x the body
- Little or no lower wick
- Must appear after a clear uptrend

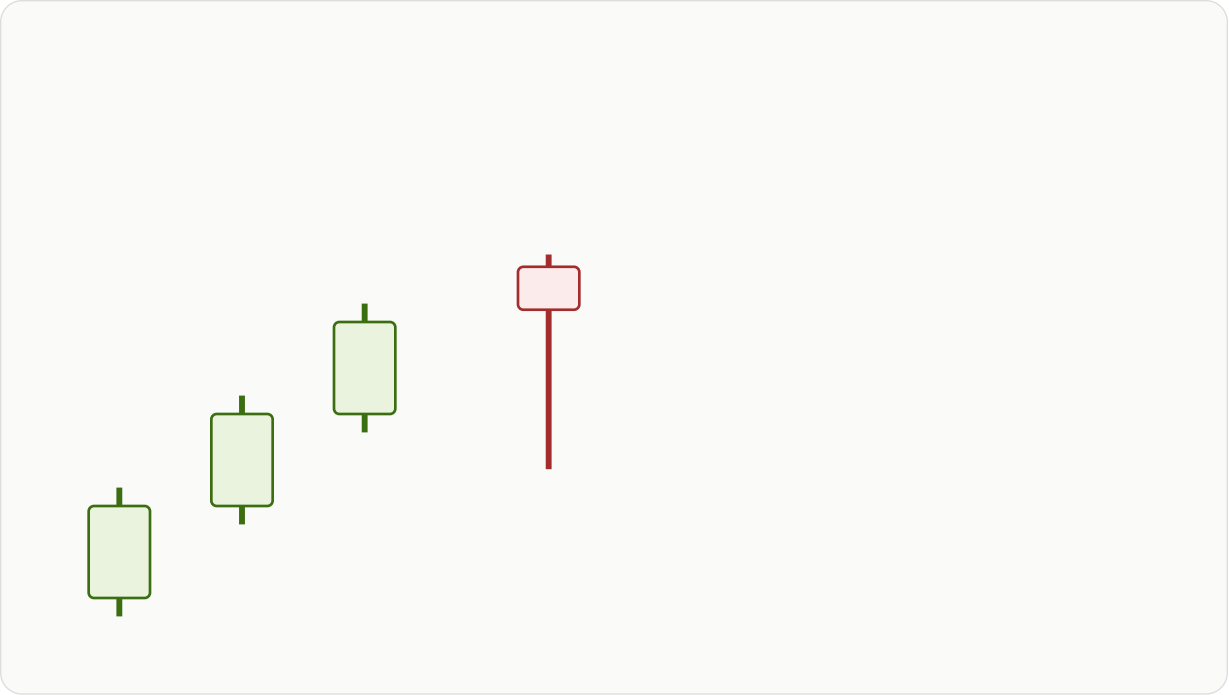
HOW TO USE IT

Wait for the next candle to close lower before acting.

PATTERN 4 OF 15 | BEARISH REVERSAL

Hanging Man

After an uptrend



What it means

It looks exactly like a hammer, but it appears after a rise. Sellers showed up and pushed price down hard during the session, even though buyers recovered. That is an early warning.

What to look for

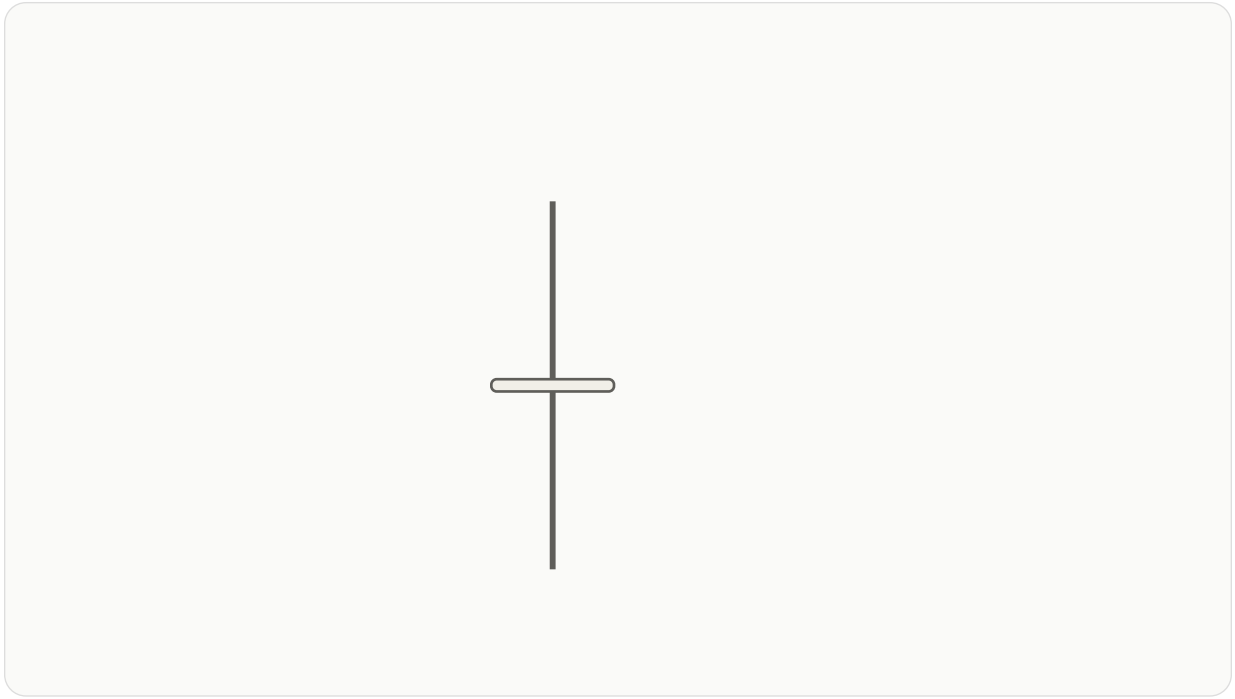
- Small body near the top
- Long lower wick, at least 2x the body
- Little or no upper wick
- Must appear after a clear uptrend

HOW TO USE IT

Needs confirmation. A red candle right after makes the warning real.

Doji

After a strong trend it can signal a turn



What it means

The market moved up and down during the session but closed exactly where it opened. Buyers and sellers are tied. After a strong trend, it says the trend is losing steam.

What to look for

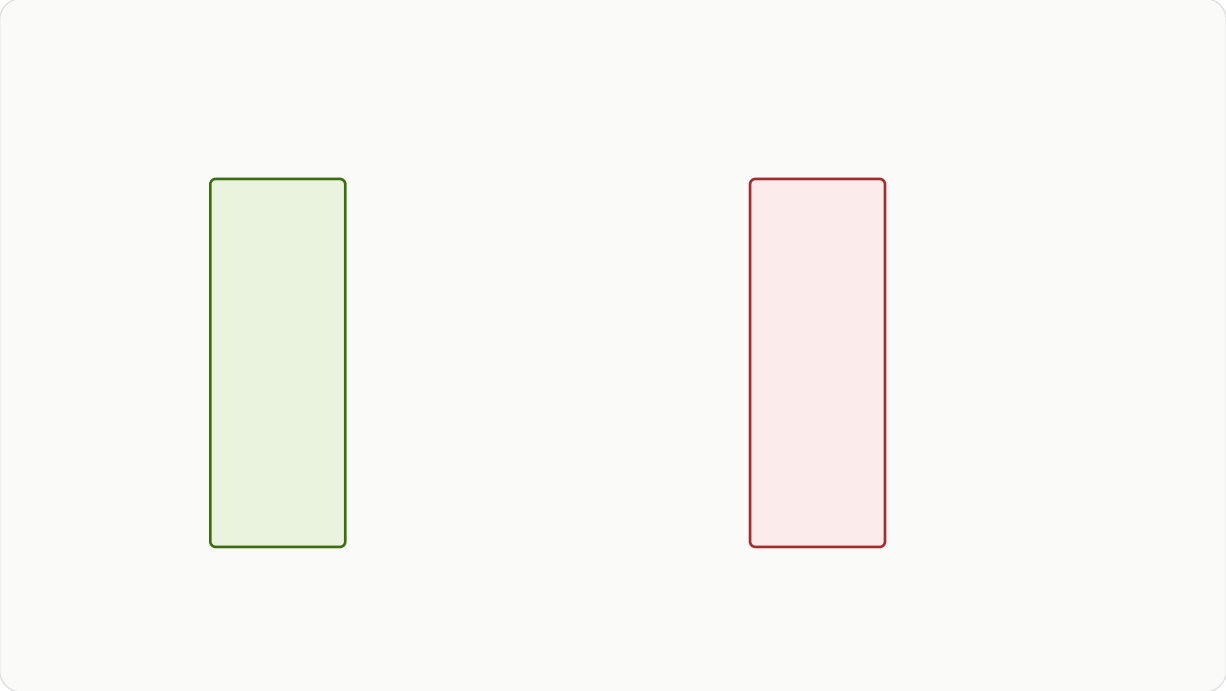
- Open and close are almost the same price
- Body is a thin line
- Wicks can be long or short
- Context decides the meaning

HOW TO USE IT

Not a signal on its own. Look at the candle that follows.

Marubozu

Green = bullish, red = bearish



What it means

One side controlled the entire session from open to close. A big green marubozu shows strong buying; a big red one shows strong selling. No wicks means no pushback at all.

What to look for

- Full body with no wicks (or tiny ones)
- Green: opened at the low, closed at the high
- Red: opened at the high, closed at the low
- Bigger body = stronger conviction

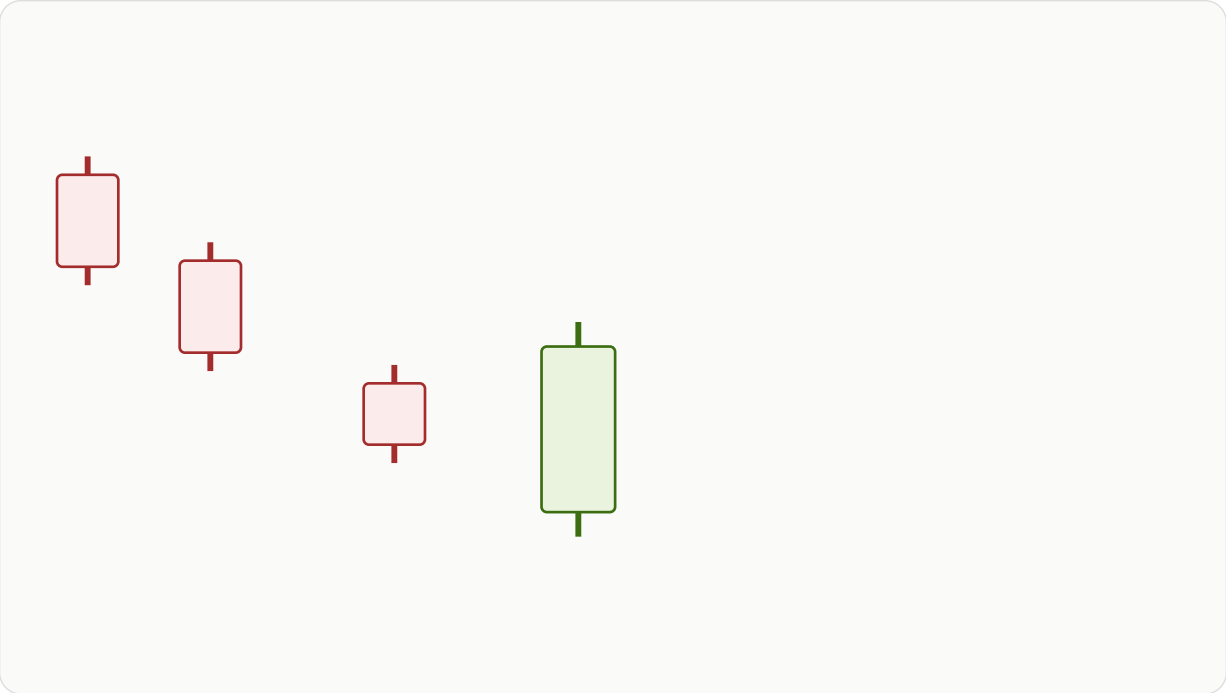
HOW TO USE IT

Often signals the trend will continue in that color's direction.

PATTERN 7 OF 15 | BULLISH REVERSAL

Bullish Engulfing

After a downtrend



What it means

A small red candle is followed by a big green candle whose body completely covers it. Buyers overwhelmed sellers in a single session.

What to look for

- Two candles after a downtrend
- First is red, second is green
- Green body fully covers the red body
- Bigger green body = stronger signal

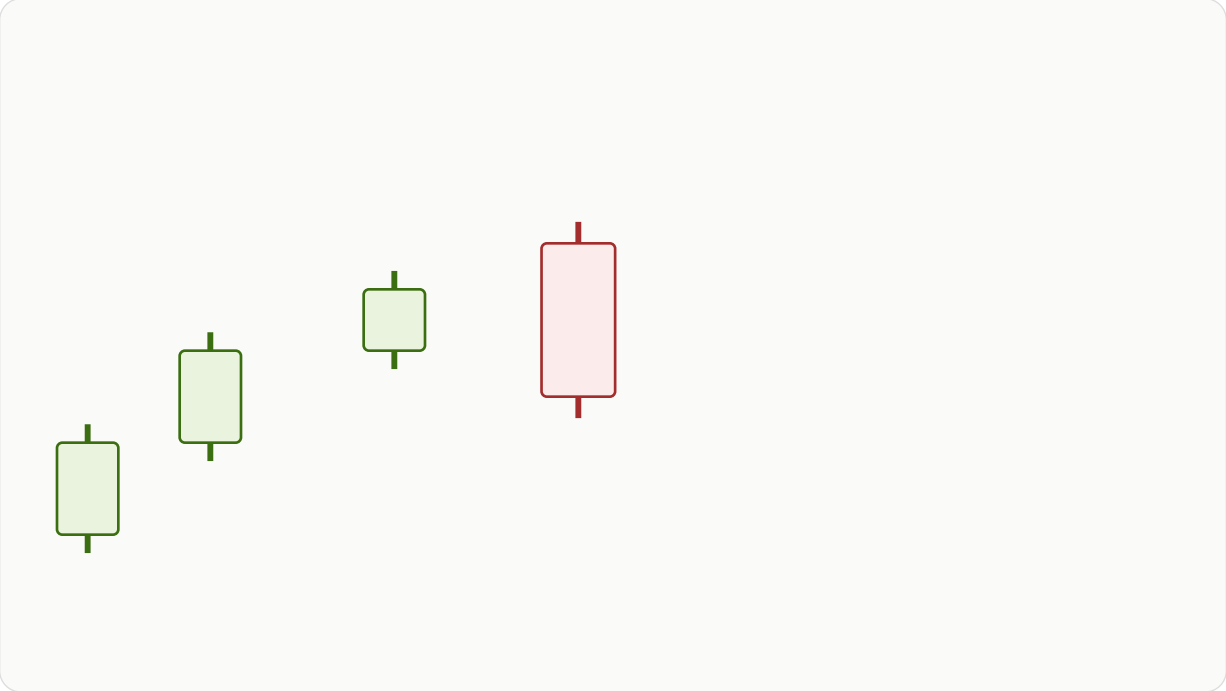
HOW TO USE IT

A strong reversal signal. Confirm with a follow-up green candle.

PATTERN 8 OF 15 | BEARISH REVERSAL

Bearish Engulfing

After an uptrend



What it means

A small green candle is followed by a big red candle whose body completely covers it. Sellers took full control and erased the buyers' last effort.

What to look for

- Two candles after an uptrend
- First is green, second is red
- Red body fully covers the green body
- Bigger red body = stronger signal

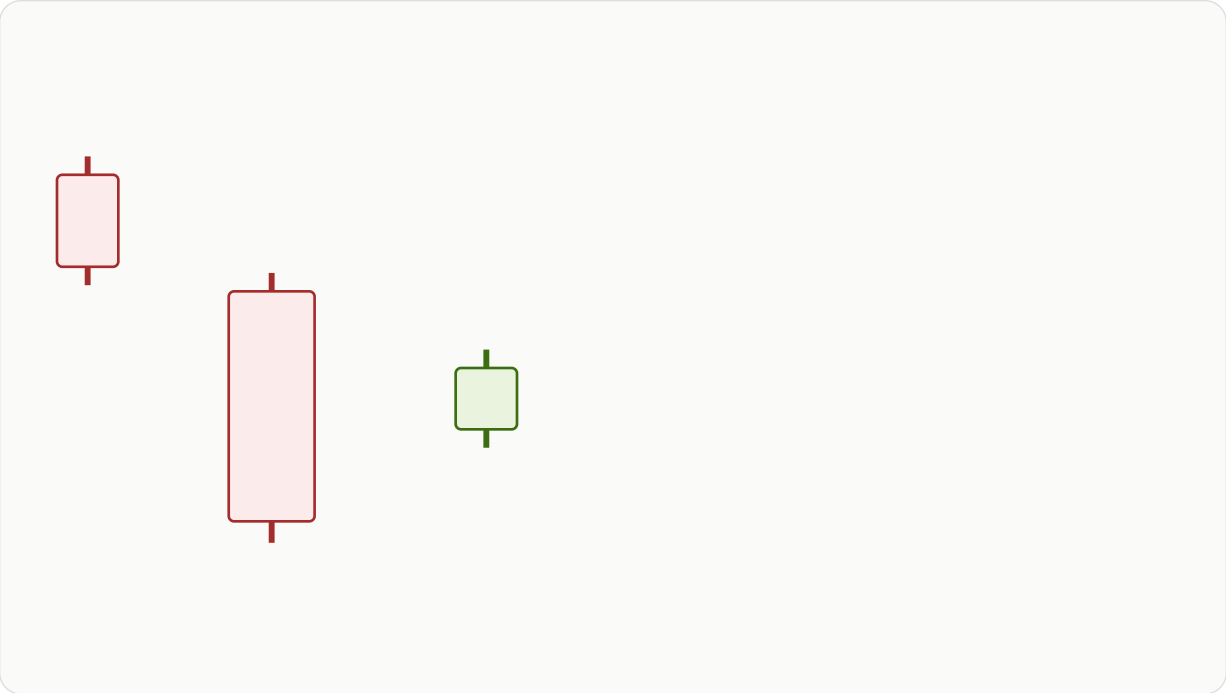
HOW TO USE IT

A strong reversal signal. Confirm with a follow-up red candle.

PATTERN 9 OF 15 | BULLISH REVERSAL

Bullish Harami

After a downtrend



What it means

A big red candle is followed by a small green candle that sits entirely inside its body. The selling momentum is fading.

What to look for

- Big red candle in a downtrend
- Small green candle inside the red body
- Shows slowing sellers, not yet a buyer takeover

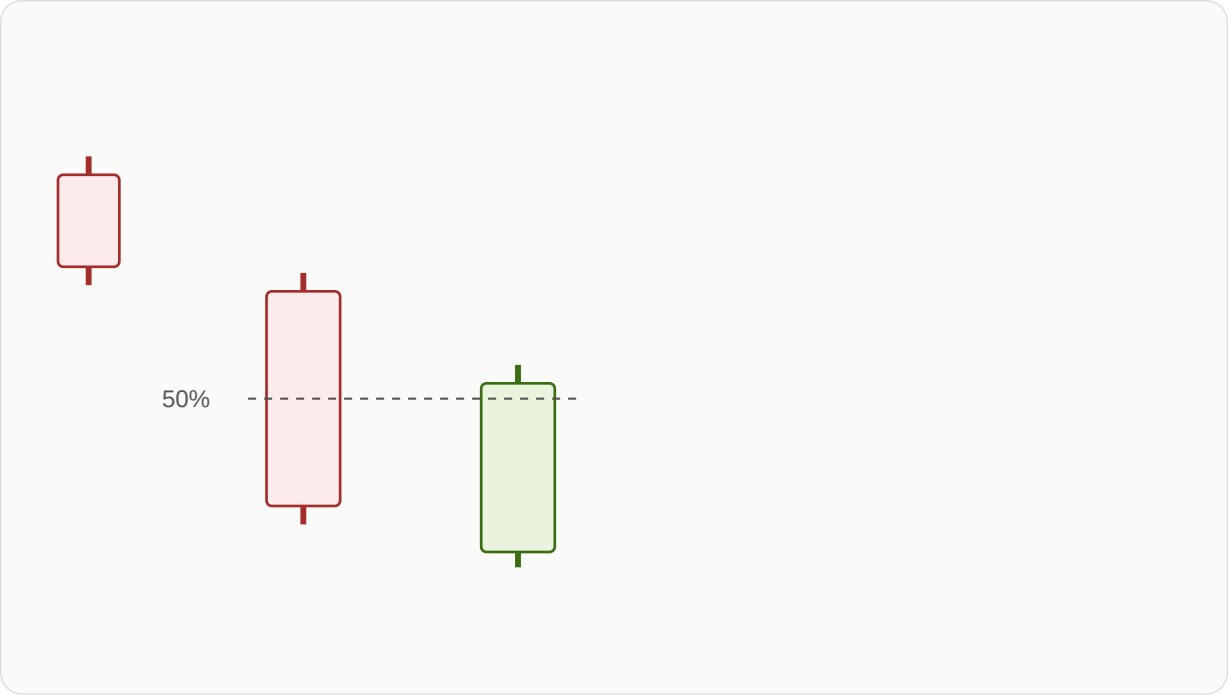
HOW TO USE IT

A weaker signal than engulfing. Wait for confirmation.

PATTERN 10 OF 15 | BULLISH REVERSAL

Piercing Line

After a downtrend



What it means

Price gaps down after a red candle, then buyers claw back more than half of it. The close above the dashed midpoint shows buyers regaining control.

What to look for

- Big red candle first
- Green candle opens below the red low or close
- Green closes above the red candle's midpoint
- Does not fully cover it (that would be engulfing)

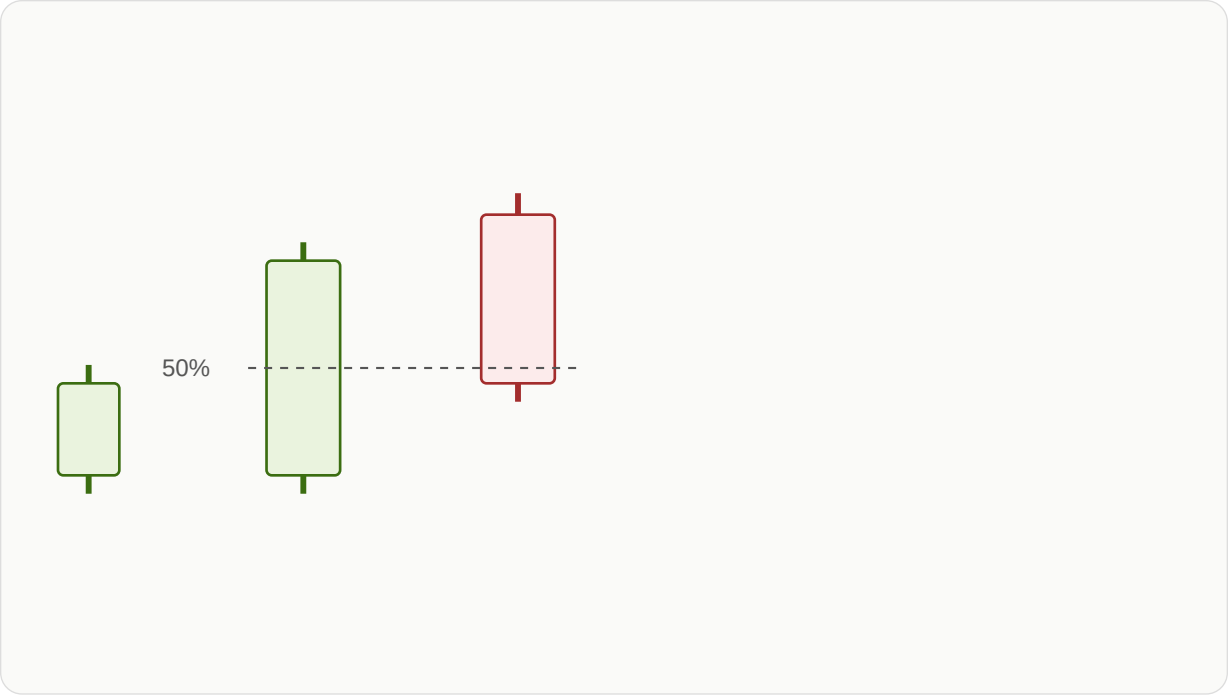
HOW TO USE IT

Confirm with the next candle closing higher.

PATTERN 11 OF 15 | BEARISH REVERSAL

Dark Cloud Cover

After an uptrend



What it means

Price gaps up after a green candle, then sellers drag it back below the halfway point. It is the bearish twin of the piercing line.

What to look for

- Big green candle first
- Red candle opens above the green high or close
- Red closes below the green candle's midpoint
- Does not fully cover it (that would be engulfing)

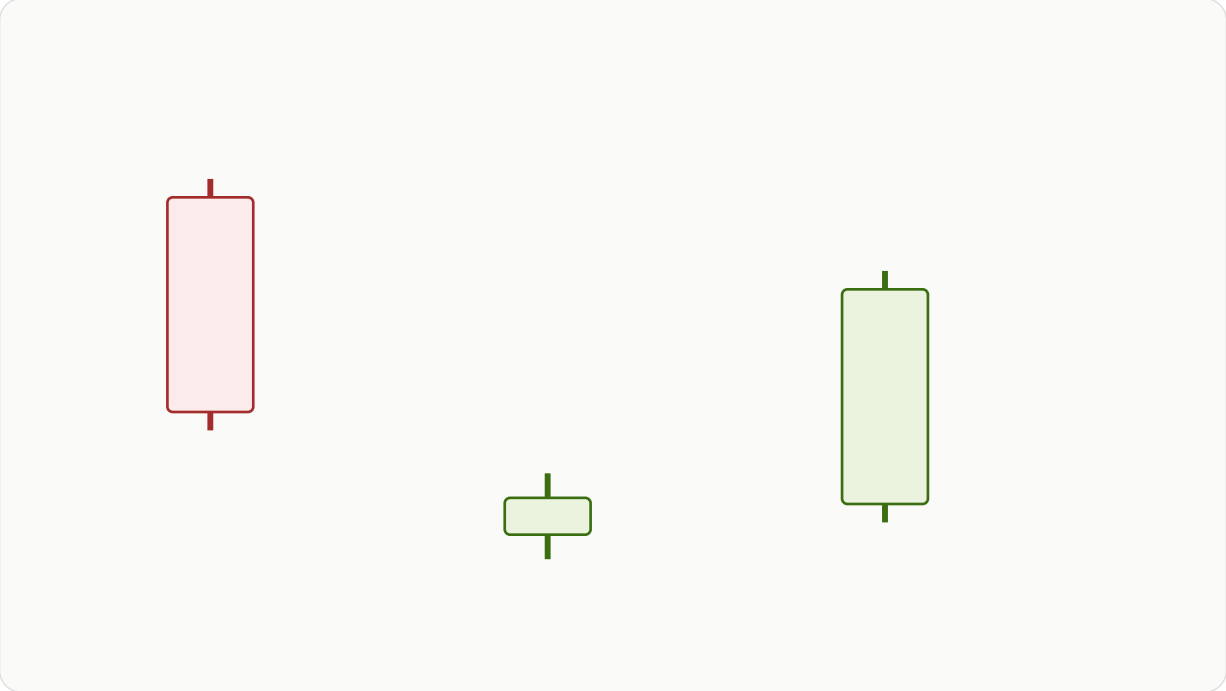
HOW TO USE IT

Confirm with the next candle closing lower.

PATTERN 12 OF 15 | BULLISH REVERSAL

Morning Star

After a downtrend, 3 candles



What it means

Like sunrise after the dark: a big red candle (sellers), a small star that gaps down (indecision), then a big green candle (buyers take over).

What to look for

- 1. Big red candle
- 2. Small star candle that gaps down
- 3. Big green candle closing deep into candle 1
- Stronger if the third candle closes above candle 1's midpoint

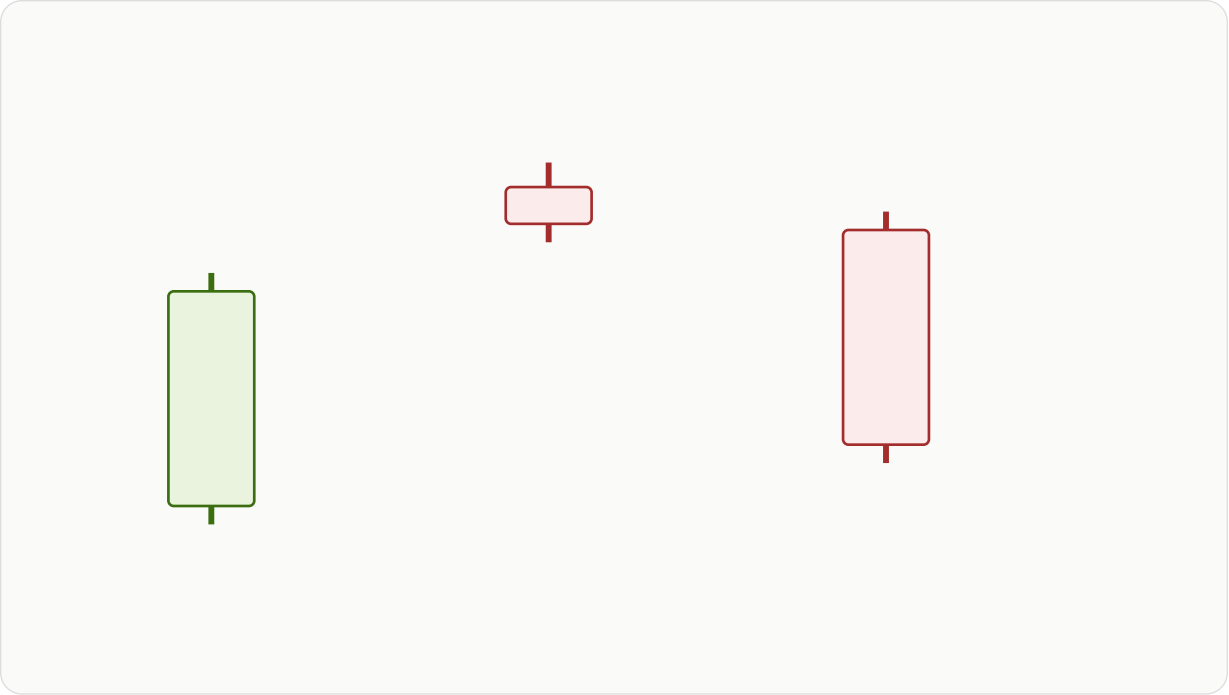
HOW TO USE IT

One of the more reliable bottom signals. Confirm with follow-through.

PATTERN 13 OF 15 | BEARISH REVERSAL

Evening Star

After an uptrend, 3 candles



What it means

The mirror of the morning star: a big green candle (buyers), a small star that gaps up (indecision), then a big red candle (sellers take over).

What to look for

- 1. Big green candle
- 2. Small star candle that gaps up
- 3. Big red candle closing deep into candle 1
- Stronger if the third candle closes below candle 1's midpoint

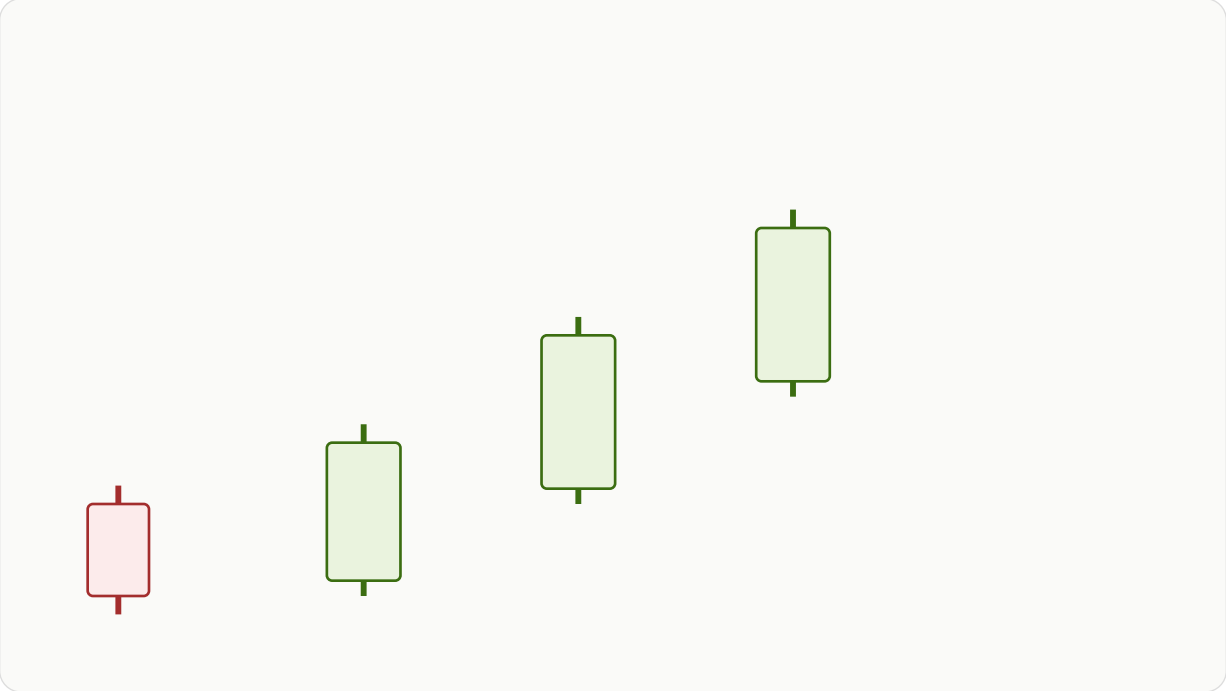
HOW TO USE IT

One of the more reliable top signals. Confirm with follow-through.

PATTERN 14 OF 15 | STRONG BULLISH

Three White Soldiers

After a downtrend or sideways market



What it means

Three long green candles in a row, each opening inside the previous body and closing higher. Steady buying with small wicks shows real conviction.

What to look for

- Three consecutive long green candles
- Each opens inside the previous body
- Each closes at or near its high
- Small upper wicks

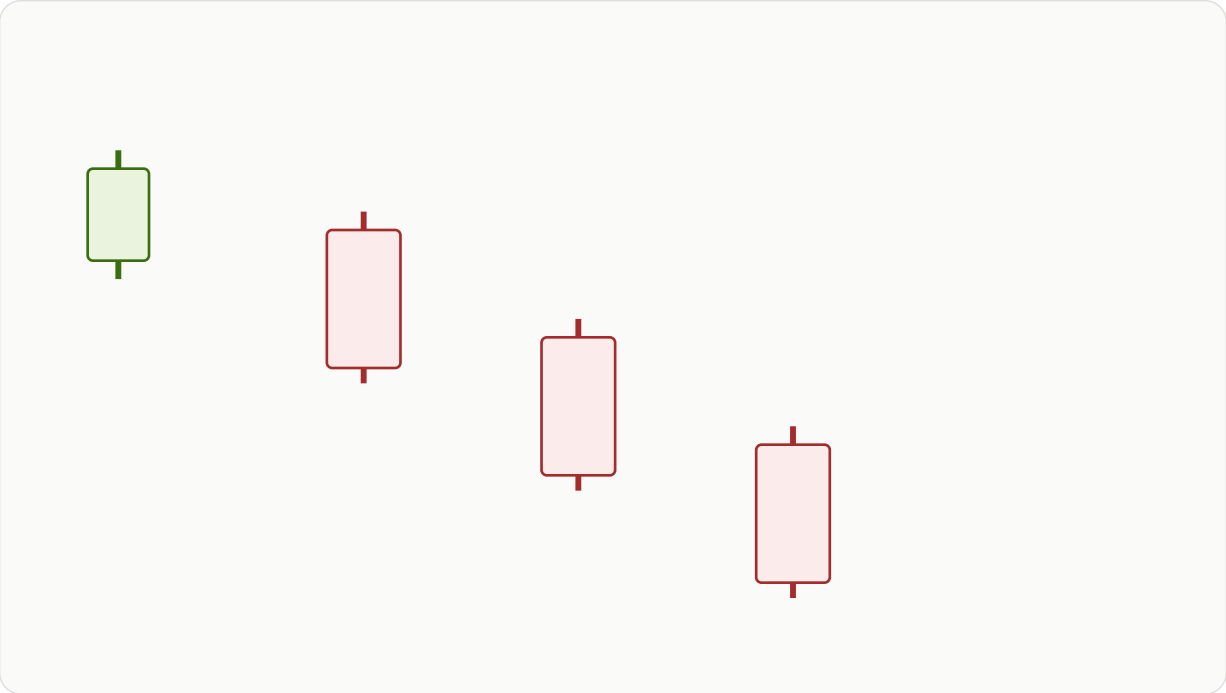
HOW TO USE IT

Be careful if the candles are huge: the move may already be overextended.

PATTERN 15 OF 15 | STRONG BEARISH

Three Black Crows

After an uptrend or sideways market



What it means

Three long red candles in a row, each opening inside the previous body and closing lower. Steady selling after a rise signals a possible trend change down.

What to look for

- Three consecutive long red candles
- Each opens inside the previous body
- Each closes at or near its low
- Small lower wicks

HOW TO USE IT

A strong sell warning. Be careful if price has already fallen a lot.